

Employee Handbook

Owning area: HR_policies

Last reviewed: August 2026

Document owner: Director of People Operations

Policy ID: HR-001

Applies to: IronStore employees, fixed-term staff, interns, and agency workers where stated

1. Purpose and Overview

This handbook sets out the main workplace standards, procedures, and employee benefits applicable across IronStore. IronStore is a European e-commerce company serving customers across multiple markets and product categories, including electronics, home essentials, clothing, outdoor equipment, beauty products, and related consumer goods.

The handbook provides a common baseline for conduct and employment practices. Local law, employment contracts, collective agreements, and formally adopted country addenda take precedence where they provide different or stronger rights.

Employees must read this handbook during onboarding and confirm completion in **PeopleHub**. Questions should be raised with the employee's manager or the People Operations Helpdesk.

2. Scope

This handbook applies to:

- Employees working from IronStore offices, warehouses, or approved remote locations.
- Employees supporting commercial, technology, fulfilment, customer service, finance, and corporate functions.
- Temporary staff and contractors when using IronStore systems or representing IronStore.
- All work-related activities, including business travel, company events, and online communications.

Country-specific requirements are maintained in **PeopleHub > Policies > Country Addenda**. Employees must follow the rules applicable to their employing entity and work location.

3. Employment Standards and Workplace Conduct

3.1 Equal treatment and inclusion

IronStore is committed to a respectful workplace. Employment decisions are based on skills, performance, qualifications, and business requirements.

Discrimination, harassment, bullying, victimisation, or retaliation is not permitted on the basis of protected characteristics under applicable law, including:

- Race, ethnic origin, nationality, or language.
- Sex, gender identity, sexual orientation, or pregnancy.
- Disability, age, religion, belief, or family status.
- Health status, trade union activity, or any other legally protected ground.

Employees should report concerns promptly to their manager, People Partner, or the confidential **Speak Up Line**. Reports are handled discreetly and investigated by authorised personnel.

3.2 Professional behaviour

Employees are expected to:

- Communicate respectfully with colleagues, customers, suppliers, and delivery partners.
- Follow reasonable management instructions and approved operating procedures.
- Protect confidential information and use company resources appropriately.
- Declare conflicts of interest before participating in related decisions.
- Keep records accurate, complete, and suitable for audit.

Threatening behaviour, intimidation, violence, deliberate dishonesty, and working while impaired by alcohol or drugs may result in disciplinary action.

3.3 Dress and personal presentation

Dress should be appropriate to the role, workplace, safety requirements, and customer or supplier interaction. Warehouse and operational employees must wear required protective equipment. Managers may provide reasonable role-specific guidance without applying discriminatory standards.

4. Working Arrangements and Attendance

4.1 Working hours

Working hours are stated in the employment contract or local schedule. Employees must comply with applicable working-time, rest-break, and maximum-hours rules.

For standard office roles:

- Core collaboration hours are normally **09:30–15:30 local time**.
- Teams may set different coverage hours for customer support, fulfilment, and incident response.
- Overtime or additional hours require advance manager approval, except in emergencies.
- Employees must record time where required by local law or team procedure.

Employees must take legally required breaks and daily or weekly rest periods. Managers are responsible for monitoring workload and preventing sustained excessive hours.

4.2 Hybrid and remote work

Eligible roles may use hybrid work under the applicable **Hybrid Working Standard HR-014** and local arrangements. Approval is based on role requirements, team coverage, performance, security, and local tax or employment restrictions.

Remote employees must:

- Work from an approved location recorded in PeopleHub.
- Maintain reliable internet access and a suitable, safe workspace.
- Protect screens, documents, devices, and calls from unauthorised access.
- Attend required office, team, training, or customer meetings.
- Obtain approval before working from another country.

Working outside the employing country for more than **10 business days in a calendar year** requires review by People Operations and Global Mobility before travel.

4.3 Attendance and absence

Employees must notify their manager as soon as possible, normally before their scheduled start time, when they cannot work. Absence records and medical documentation must be submitted through PeopleHub in accordance with local law.

Managers should contact People Operations when:

- Absence lasts more than three consecutive working days.
- A pattern of repeated short-term absence is identified.
- Workplace adjustments or a phased return may be required.
- An employee is absent without notification for one working day.

IronStore handles health information as confidential special-category data and limits access to authorised personnel.

5. Leave and Time Off

Leave entitlements are governed by the employment contract and local law. PeopleHub is the system of record for requests and balances.

5.1 Annual leave

Employees should request annual leave at least **10 calendar days** in advance through PeopleHub. Managers should respond within five business days and must consider operational coverage fairly.

Employees should not book non-refundable travel until leave is approved. Leave carry-over, minimum usage, and expiry rules differ by country. The relevant country addendum applies.

5.2 Public holidays and other leave

Public holidays follow the employee's employing entity and approved work location. Statutory leave may include parental, family, bereavement, sick, civic, and other protected leave.

Employees should contact their People Partner before taking statutory or extended leave so that documentation, pay, benefits, and return-to-work arrangements can be confirmed.

5.3 Family and personal circumstances

IronStore seeks to support employees with caring responsibilities, disability, pregnancy, or other significant personal circumstances. Reasonable adjustments may include changes to working hours, equipment, duties, or location, subject to operational feasibility and local requirements.

Requests should be discussed with the manager and People Partner. Medical information should be provided only through approved confidential channels.

6. Pay, Expenses, and Benefits

6.1 Payroll

Salary is paid monthly to the bank account registered in PeopleHub. Payroll cut-off is normally the **15th calendar day** of each month. Changes submitted after cut-off may be processed in the following pay cycle.

Employees must check payslips and report suspected errors to **Payroll Operations** within 30 days. IronStore may correct overpayments in accordance with local law and agreed repayment arrangements.

6.2 Business expenses

Reasonable, necessary business expenses must be submitted in **SpendFlow** within **30 days** of the transaction. Receipts are required for expenses over **€25**, unless local rules require receipts at a lower threshold.

Prior approval is required for:

- Travel or accommodation expected to exceed **€500**.
- Customer or supplier hospitality above **€75 per person**.
- Equipment or subscriptions above the team's delegated budget.
- Any expense involving a government official.

Expenses must be accurate and must not be split to avoid approval thresholds. Personal purchases are not reimbursable unless explicitly authorised.

6.3 Benefits

Benefits vary by employing entity and may include pension contributions, health coverage, employee discounts, wellbeing support, and income protection. Current eligibility and enrolment information is available in PeopleHub. Employees must notify People Operations of relevant changes, such as a change in dependants or address.

7. Information Security, Privacy, and Company Property

Employees are responsible for protecting IronStore data, customer information, and company equipment.

Required practices include:

- Use **IronID** multi-factor authentication for company systems.
- Store work files in approved services such as **IronDrive** and **Confluence**.
- Do not share passwords, tokens, or access badges.
- Use company-managed devices for customer, payment, employee, and operational data.
- Lock screens when unattended and report lost devices immediately.
- Check unexpected links, invoices, and payment requests before acting.
- Complete annual security and privacy training by the assigned deadline.

Suspected phishing, data loss, unauthorised access, or accidental disclosure must be reported immediately through **SecurityHub** or the 24-hour on-call number listed in the Service Portal. Do not attempt to conceal or independently investigate an incident.

IronStore processes personal data under applicable privacy laws, including the GDPR where relevant. Employees may access personal data only when required for their role and must follow retention and deletion instructions.

Company equipment remains IronStore property. On transfer or termination, all equipment, records, access cards, and confidential materials must be returned by the date specified by IT or People Operations.

8. Conflicts, Gifts, and Business Integrity

Employees must act in IronStore's interests and disclose actual or potential conflicts to their manager and Compliance.

Employees may accept modest, infrequent business hospitality when it is lawful, transparent, and not intended to influence a decision. Gifts or hospitality valued above **€50** require manager approval and entry in the **Gifts and Hospitality Register**. Gifts from suppliers involved in a current tender or contract negotiation must normally be declined.

The following are prohibited:

- Bribery, facilitation payments, kickbacks, or secret commissions.
- Falsifying records, invoices, performance data, or customer information.
- Using confidential company information for personal benefit.
- Retaliating against someone who raises a good-faith concern.

Concerns may be reported through the Speak Up Line, anonymously where legally available.

9. Performance, Learning, and Development

Employees receive role objectives through **PerformTrack**. Managers should provide regular feedback and hold at least quarterly check-ins. Annual reviews normally close in January for the preceding performance year.

Employees are expected to:

- Complete mandatory compliance, security, and safety training on time.
- Maintain skills relevant to their role.
- Discuss development goals during quarterly check-ins.
- Participate in improvement plans where performance does not meet expectations.

Performance concerns should be addressed promptly, fairly, and with documented expectations, support, and review dates. Formal processes must follow local law and any applicable collective agreement.

10. Health, Safety, and Wellbeing

IronStore provides a safe working environment and requires employees to follow site-specific safety instructions.

Employees must:

- Complete required workplace or warehouse induction before starting relevant work.
- Use protective equipment and follow manual-handling procedures.
- Report hazards, injuries, near misses, and unsafe behaviour through **SafeTrack**.
- Follow emergency, evacuation, fire, and first-aid instructions.
- Never disable safety controls or operate equipment without authorisation.

Work-related injuries must be reported to the manager immediately and recorded before the end of the shift where possible. Mental health support is available through the Employee Assistance Programme, listed in PeopleHub.

11. Leaving IronStore

Resignation must be submitted in writing to the manager and People Operations. Notice periods follow the employment contract and local law.

Before the final working day, employees must:

- Complete knowledge transfer and return company property.
- Close or transfer open work in approved systems.
- Submit outstanding expenses and timesheets.
- Remove company data from personal devices.
- Attend an exit discussion where requested.

System access may be withdrawn before the final day based on security, role, or business requirements. Post-employment confidentiality obligations continue after departure.

12. Roles and Responsibilities

- **Employees:** Follow this handbook, local policies, security requirements, and lawful instructions.

- **Managers:** Apply standards consistently, approve requests promptly, support wellbeing, and escalate issues.
- **People Partners:** Advise on employment matters, workplace concerns, leave, adjustments, and formal processes.
- **People Operations:** Maintain records, policies, payroll coordination, and employee support channels.
- **Information Security and Privacy:** Manage security controls, incidents, access, and data-protection guidance.
- **Compliance:** Maintain integrity standards, investigations, and the Speak Up process.

13. Related Documents and References

- HR-014 Hybrid Working Standard
- HR-021 Leave and Attendance Procedure
- HR-030 Disciplinary and Grievance Procedure
- SEC-005 Acceptable Use and Access Control Standard
- PRIV-002 Employee and Customer Data Protection Policy
- COM-003 Anti-Bribery, Gifts, and Hospitality Policy
- HSE-001 Workplace Health and Safety Standard
- Country-specific employment contracts and PeopleHub addenda

14. Revision History

- **August 2026 — Version 4.0:** Annual review; updated hybrid work, security reporting, expense thresholds, and country-addenda references.
- **January 2025 — Version 3.2:** Added remote-work country restrictions and revised Speak Up process.
- **September 2023 — Version 3.0:** Consolidated conduct, leave, data protection, and workplace safety guidance.